

MAINTAINING A GOOD ATTITUDE IN DIFFICULT TIMES

TEXT: Numbers 13:26-33 (NKJV) *“Now they departed and came back to Moses and Aaron and all the congregation of the children of Israel in the Wilderness of Paran, at Kadesh; they brought back word to them and to all the congregation, and showed them the fruit of the land. 27 Then they told him, and said: “We went to the land where you sent us. It truly flows with milk and honey, and this is its fruit. 28 Nevertheless the people who dwell in the land are strong; the cities are fortified and very large; moreover we saw the descendants of Anak there. 29 The Amalekites dwell in the land of the South; the Hittites, the Jebusites, and the Amorites dwell in the mountains; and the Canaanites dwell by the sea and along the banks of the Jordan.” 30 Then Caleb quieted the people before Moses, and said, “Let us go up at once and take possession, for we are well able to overcome it.” 31 But the men who had gone up with him said, “We are not able to go up against the people, for they are stronger than we.” 32 And they gave the children of Israel a bad report of the land which they had spied out, saying, “The land through which we have gone as spies is a land that devours its inhabitants, and all the people whom we saw in it are men of great stature. 33 There we saw the giants^[u] (the descendants of Anak came from the giants); and we were like grasshoppers in our own sight, and so we were in their sight.”*

[Numbers 14:24](#) (NKJV) ***“But My servant Caleb, because he has a different spirit in him and has followed Me fully, I will bring into the land where he went, and his descendants shall inherit it.”***

INTRO: The predominant sin of Israel during the course of it's pursuit of the Promised Land was the sin of half-heartedness. The very reason for forty years spent wandering around in the wilderness is because of half-heartedness. [Numbers 32:23](#) (NKJV) ***“...Be sure your sin will find you out.”*** My mother used to scare me to death with this Scripture; I thought everything I had ever done would eventually come to light. We all know there are many sins which a person commits which are never revealed. If we confess our sins while God is still dealing with us in mercy he covers them from public view and forgets them for eternity! If this is the case, what could this Scripture possibly mean?

This Scripture deals exclusively with the sin of half-heartedness. In reality, [half-heartedness is simply a stubborn refusal to wholly follow God!](#) In this Scripture Moses is telling the tribes of Reuben and Gad that their sin was one of half-heartedness. They were requesting to stay on the other side of Jordan! [Numbers 32:4-5](#) (NKJV) ***“The country which the Lord defeated before the congregation of Israel, is a land for livestock, and your servants have livestock.⁵ Therefore they said, “If we have found favor in your sight, let this land be given to your servants as a possession. Do not take us over the Jordan.”***

Moses is saying to these tribes of Israel that the sin of half-heartedness would cost them dearly. The sin of half-heartedness will always bring devastating consequences into the lives of those affected by it.

God always judges the sin of half-heartedness:

- On the job...
- In the home...
- In all relationships...
- In the area of finances...
- In our spiritual walk with God...

Numbers 14:29 (NKJV) ***"The carcasses of you who have complained against Me shall fall in this wilderness, all of you who were numbered, according to your entire number, from twenty years old and above."***

Numbers 14:36-37 (NKJV) ***"Now the men whom Moses sent to spy out the land, who returned and made all the congregation complain against him by bringing a bad report of the land, 37 those very men who brought the evil report about the land, died by the plague before the Lord."***

The sin of half-heartedness manifested itself at the Red Sea, at the first sign of danger they were ready to go back to Egypt. When they arrived in Kadesh Barnea this malady was alive and well and because of it, they turned thumbs down on a golden opportunity to inherit the Promised Land. The fact that they did not believe they could conquer Canaan is astounding to me when they were already forty miles inside the land when they made such an asinine decision.

Israel's sin of half-heartedness provoked the Lord. Notice what Paul has to say about the provocation of Israel. [1 Corinthians 10:1-11](#) (NKJV) ***"Moreover, brethren, I do not want you to be unaware that all our fathers were under the cloud, all passed through the sea, 2 all were baptized into Moses in the cloud and in the sea, 3 all ate the same spiritual food, 4 and all drank the same spiritual drink. For they drank of that spiritual Rock that followed them, and that Rock was Christ. 5 But with most of them God was not well pleased, for their bodies were scattered in the wilderness. 6 Now these things became our examples, to the intent that we should not lust after evil things as they also lusted. 7 And do not become idolaters as were some of them. As it is written, "The people sat down to eat and drink, and rose up to play." 8 Nor let us commit sexual immorality, as some of them did, and in one day twenty-three thousand fell; 9 nor let us tempt Christ, as some of them also tempted, and were destroyed by serpents; 10 nor complain, as some of them also complained, and were destroyed by the destroyer. 11 Now all these things happened to them as examples, and they were written for our admonition, upon whom the ends of the ages have come."***

These people would have been better off to have judged themselves! [1 Peter 4:17](#) (NKJV) ***"For the time has come for judgment to begin at the house of God; and if it begins with us first, what will be the end of those who do not obey the gospel of God?"***

If the modern day church is going to escape the judgment of God we must make up our minds to avoid the trap of half-heartedness, and go all the way with the Lord! [Colossians 3:1-3](#) (NKJV) ***"If then you were raised with Christ, seek those things which are above, where Christ is, sitting at the right hand of God. 2 Set your mind on things above, not on things on the earth. 3 For you died, and your life is hidden with Christ in God."***

Jesus said, [Luke 12:34](#) (NKJV) ***"For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also."***

Three things will happen to those who refuse to wholly follow the Lord:

- They will have no strength or discernment to deal with the over-powering on-slots of hell...
- Their spiritual life will lose its fervor day by day...
- The presence of the Lord will be lost and hopelessness will set in...

I believe the Lord is looking throughout the land for people who will seek him fully and keep His goal in focus while maintaining a good attitude in spite of difficulty.

In our text, we are introduced to one of the Bible's most prolific and successful characters, Caleb. One of the greatest compliments in the Word of God is paid to this little known Old Testament character. [Numbers 14:24](#) (NKJV) ***"But My servant Caleb, because he has a different spirit in him and has followed Me***

fully, I will bring into the land where he went, and his descendants shall inherit it.”

Caleb had a good spirit about him. He was not a joy-drainer, or a melancholy Christian! **Caleb had a spirit of;**

- Composure...
- Conquest...
- Confidence...
- Conviction...

I. CALEB HAD A SPIRIT OF COMPOSURE...

Caleb was an ordinary man with an extraordinary purpose. As far as men go, Caleb would probably not have stood out in the crowd. His name could have been Smith, Jones, or Harris; he was an ordinary sort of a guy. What set Caleb apart were his purpose and the stick-to-it-ness. The Bible declared that ***“He had another spirit from the Lord...”***

In order for us who are in this room today to take a step from the arena of the ordinary to the world of the extraordinary, it will take the same things which Caleb had to assimilate into his life.

Caleb was not your average run-of-the-mill, pink-fingered, tip-toe-through-the-tulips, kind of sissy. He was the guy who was ready to take on a challenge at a moments notice. No matter what the crisis, even in the midst of an evil report, Caleb said, *“let’s go-get-em’!”*

Caleb was expressing faith when the tide of public opinion was diametrically opposed to his point of view. A poll was taken by Moses and 83.33% of the people were saying just the opposite of what Caleb had in mind. He **was outnumbered 5 to 1!** Caleb did not allow the tide of public opinion to determine his faith, he knew God was able to deliver and he was ready to do his part in the battle.

Caleb was surrounded by negativity. When public opinion becomes negative it is easy to just side with the majority and fail to have our voice heard. This is not the case with Caleb, when others are stating the reasons why it would be impossible for Israel to prevail; he made unwavering declarations of faith in Israel and Israel's God!

Notice **Numbers 13:26-30** (NKJV) ***"Now they departed and came back to Moses and Aaron and all the congregation of the children of Israel in the Wilderness of Paran, at Kadesh; they brought back word to them and to all the congregation, and showed them the fruit of the land. 27 Then they told him, and said: "We went to the land where you sent us. It truly flows with milk and honey, and this is its fruit. 28 Nevertheless the people who dwell in the land are strong; the cities are fortified and very large; moreover we saw the descendants of Anak there. 29 The Amalekites dwell in the land of the South; the Hittites, the Jebusites, and the Amorites dwell in the mountains; and the Canaanites dwell by the sea and along the banks of the Jordan." 30 Then Caleb quieted the people before Moses, and said, "Let us go***

up at once and take possession, for we are well able to overcome it." Caleb said SHHHH!!!!!!

If we hope to demonstrate a spirit of composure in a faithless situation we must get our eyes off of people and get them on the captain of the Lord's Host!

If we keep our eyes on the Lord we can remain calm cool and collected no matter how difficult the situation becomes. We are not under the circumstances, but we've got a God who is God in spite of the circumstances!

God says to Moses, [Exodus 33:21-23](#) (NKJV) ***"And the Lord said, "Here is a place by Me, and you shall stand on the rock. 22 So it shall be, while My glory passes by, that I will put you in the cleft of the rock, and will cover you with My hand while I pass by. 23 Then I will take away My hand, and you shall see My back; but My face shall not be seen."***

David said in Psalms [61:1-3](#) (NKJV) ***"To the Chief Musician. On a stringed instrument. A Psalm of David. Hear my cry, O God; Attend to my prayer. 2 From the end of the earth I will cry to You, When my heart is overwhelmed; Lead me to the rock that is higher than I. 3 For You have been a shelter for me, A strong tower from the enemy."***

Isaiah found a place of composure in spite of the circumstances, [Isaiah 6:1-8](#) (NKJV) ***"In the year that King Uzziah died, I saw the Lord sitting on a throne, high and lifted up, and the train of His robe filled the temple. 2 Above it stood seraphim; each one had six***

wings: with two he covered his face, with two he covered his feet, and with two he flew. 3 And one cried to another and said: "Holy, holy, holy is the Lord of hosts; The whole earth is full of His glory!" 4 And the posts of the door were shaken by the voice of him who cried out, and the house was filled with smoke. 5 So I said: "Woe is me, for I am undone! Because I am a man of unclean lips, And I dwell in the midst of a people of unclean lips; For my eyes have seen the King, The Lord of hosts." 6 Then one of the seraphim flew to me, having in his hand a live coal which he had taken with the tongs from the altar. 7 And he touched my mouth with it, and said: "Behold, this has touched your lips; Your iniquity is taken away, And your sin purged." 8 Also I heard the voice of the Lord, saying: "Whom shall I send, And who will go for Us?" Then I said, "Here am I! Send me."

There's an old black spiritual that goes something like this, "If you've never heard nothing, and never seen nothing, and never felt nothing, then brother you ain't got nothing yet!"

In Caleb's case there were 10 grasshoppers and two giant killers! [The difference between grasshoppers and giant killers is the ability to maintain a good attitude in difficult times.](#) This can only be achieved through a spirit of composure!

II. CALEB HAD A SPIRIT OF CONQUEST...

Notice the words of Caleb, [Numbers 13:30](#) (NKJV)

"Then Caleb quieted the people before Moses, and

said, "Let us go up at once and take possession, for we are well able to overcome it."

There's a time to pray, and a time to act! It is easy to get into the stall mode using the excuse; we are praying about it. What would we say to our children if they kept asking about something they already knew the answer to? Rhetorical questions can run a little thin after a while. A failure to properly discern whether it is time to pray or time to act can be costly. In this case I believe Israel could have achieved victory if they had just taken the advice of Caleb, closed the discussion and began the process of dividing and conquering the land!

The majority of the leadership of Israel wanted something-for-nothing! They had lived as slaves for more than four hundred years; because of this; they did not know how to achieve one thing which was not being handed to them. In order to properly understand the historical significance of Israel and it's relation to us you must first come to grips with three symbolic facts:

- Egypt symbolizes the unregenerate life...
- The wilderness symbolizes the life of the believer after conversion...
- Canaan symbolizes the Spirit filled life...

If we are not constantly on our guard we can very easily fall into the trap of living in the same kind of slave mentality which kept Israel from the Promised Land. If a thing is being freely offered without any challenge, we are willing to accept it. However, if

effort is required on our part, we seem to lose our courage. (Most of the problem in winning in Iraq is a lack of courage on the part of the U.S. public!)

The things worth having in life require a price to be paid!

- Career...
- Marriage...
- Parenthood...
- Spiritual walk...

If we are not willing to pay the price, we will probably never be in possession of those things. If we in fact achieve them there will very likely be a price to pay!

This reminds me of a letter that I heard about recently to the Secretary of Agriculture. It says, and I quote:

Dear Mr. Secretary,

My friend Bordeaux recently received a check for \$1,000.00 from the government for not raising hogs! So, I want to go into the business of not raising hogs! It seems to pay off pretty well.

Mr. Secretary, one of the first things I will need to know is what is the best kind of land not to raise hogs on? And what is the best kind of hogs not to raise?

I suppose the most difficult part of this business is going to be keeping an individual record of each hog I do not raise!

My friend Bordeaux has been raising hogs for more than 20 years and suddenly he received a \$1,000.00 check for not raising hogs! Now if I get \$1,000.00 for not raising 50 hogs, will I get \$2,000.00 for not raising 100 hogs?

Mr. Secretary, I plan to start off on a small scale holding myself down to not raising more than 400 hogs for which the government will pay me \$8,000.00.

Now these hogs I will not raise will not eat 100,000 bushels of corn, and I understand you are also paying farmers for not raising corn!

Will you pay me for not raising 100,000 bushels of corn, which I will not feed to the 400 hogs, which I will not be raising?

Please respond promptly as I would like to get started as soon as possible, as this looks like a good time of year for not raising hogs!

People who want something-for-nothing are generally a part of the again-it-crowd!

Those who have a spirit of conquest are willing to pay the price and persevere when the going gets tough!
They are willing to move out in obedience to God through faith!

The biggest difference between Grasshoppers and Giant Killers is eighteen inches; the distance between your head and your heart. This eighteen inch distance might well be the greatest span of space on earth! The Children of Israel knew God was giving them the land but they could not believe it with their heart. [The difference between head knowledge and heart knowledge is the difference between religion and relationship.](#)

Everything about this man Caleb portrays the fact he is a fiery soldier, summoned to a conquest, and guided to a glorious, victorious destiny! Even though he had a spirit of conquest and believed he could conquer his inheritance did not mean the going would be easy! He still had forty plus years of faithful endurance and staying in shape for battle, ahead of him.

Those who have a spirit of conquest put their own personal likes and dislikes on the back burner because they realize there is a greater destiny to be achieved.

Notice this; we don't hear one negative word from Caleb about the other 10 guys! He didn't have time to get caught up in that; he had a mountain to conquer!

[The difference between grasshoppers and giant killers is maintaining a good attitude in difficult times.](#) This can only be achieved through the realization that we realize we are more than conquerors. [Romans 8:31-39](#) (NKJV) ***“What then shall we say to these things? If God is for us, who can be against us? ³² He who did not spare His own Son, but delivered Him up for us***

all, how shall He not with Him also freely give us all things? ³³ Who shall bring a charge against God's elect? It is God who justifies. ³⁴ Who is he who condemns? It is Christ who died, and furthermore is also risen, who is even at the right hand of God, who also makes intercession for us. ³⁵ Who shall separate us from the love of Christ? Shall tribulation, or distress, or persecution, or famine, or nakedness, or peril, or sword? ³⁶ As it is written: "For Your sake we are killed all day long; We are accounted as sheep for the slaughter." ³⁷ Yet in all these things we are more than conquerors through Him who loved us. ³⁸ For I am persuaded that neither death nor life, nor angels nor principalities nor powers, nor things present nor things to come, ³⁹ nor height nor depth, nor any other created thing, shall be able to separate us from the love of God which is in Christ Jesus our Lord."

III. CALEB HAD A SPIRIT OF CONFIDENCE...

Numbers 13:30 (NKJV) *"Then Caleb quieted the people before Moses, and said, "Let us go up at once and take possession, for we are well able to overcome it."* Notice with me, **Caleb's confidence is not blind!**

He has seen the same giants all the others have seen! It is imperative that anyone who is going to fight this good fight of the Faith keep their eyes open and learn to properly evaluate the challenges which lie ahead. **1**

Peter 5:8 (NKJV) *"Be sober, be vigilant; because your adversary the devil walks about like a roaring lion, seeking whom he may devour."*

The difference between the 10 grasshoppers and the two giant killers is that in spite of what they were

facing they believed God! The eighteen inch trip from head to heart had been successfully navigated! [Psalm 103:7](#) (NKJV) ***“He made known His ways to Moses, His acts to the children of Israel.”*** The difference between the knowledge imparted to Moses and the knowledge imparted to the Children of Israel is that Moses knew God well enough to believe Him; Israel witnessed His miracles at a distance.

[Caleb’s confidence was not one of denial!](#) [Hebrews 10:35](#) (NKJV) ***“Therefore do not cast away your confidence, which has great reward.”***

He did not deny there were monumental obstacles, but his confidence said, “*Even though.....*” How could he have such confidence in the face of such overwhelming adversity? [Zechariah 4:6](#) (NKJV) ***“So he answered and said to me: ‘This is the word of the LORD to Zerubbabel: ‘Not by might nor by power, but by My Spirit,’ Says the LORD of hosts.’”***

[Romans 8:31-39](#) (NKJV) ***“What then shall we say to these things? If God is for us, who can be against us? ³² He who did not spare His own Son, but delivered Him up for us all, how shall He not with Him also freely give us all things? ³³ Who shall bring a charge against God’s elect? It is God who justifies. ³⁴ Who is he who condemns? It is Christ who died, and furthermore is also risen, who is even at the right hand of God, who also makes intercession for us. ³⁵ Who shall separate us from the love of Christ? Shall tribulation, or distress, or persecution, or famine, or nakedness, or peril, or sword? ³⁶ As it is written: “For Your sake we are killed all day long; We are***

accounted as sheep for the slaughter.”³⁷ Yet in all these things we are more than conquerors through Him who loved us.³⁸ For I am persuaded that neither death nor life, nor angels nor principalities nor powers, nor things present nor things to come,³⁹ nor height nor depth, nor any other created thing, shall be able to separate us from the love of God which is in Christ Jesus our Lord.” (Larry Burris – legs full of blood clots – doctor said you are otherwise healthy as a horse – “Nay in all these things...”)

Would the task of conquering the land be difficult because of the giants? Yes! Would the task of conquering the land be impossible because of the giants? No! [Mark 9:23](#) (NKJV) “*Jesus said to him, “If you can believe, all things are possible to him who believes.”*”

[2 Corinthians 10:3-6](#) (NKJV) “*For though we walk in the flesh, we do not war according to the flesh.⁴ For the weapons of our warfare are not carnal but mighty in God for pulling down strongholds,⁵ casting down arguments and every high thing that exalts itself against the knowledge of God, bringing every thought into captivity to the obedience of Christ,⁶ and being ready to punish all disobedience when your obedience is fulfilled.”*

[Ephesians 6:10-18](#) (NKJV) “*Finally, my brethren, be strong in the Lord and in the power of His might.¹¹ Put on the whole armor of God, that you may be able to stand against the wiles of the devil.¹² For we do*

not wrestle against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this age, against spiritual hosts of wickedness in the heavenly places.¹³ Therefore take up the whole armor of God, that you may be able to withstand in the evil day, and having done all, to stand.¹⁴ Stand therefore, having girded your waist with truth, having put on the breastplate of righteousness,¹⁵ and having shod your feet with the preparation of the gospel of peace;¹⁶ above all, taking the shield of faith with which you will be able to quench all the fiery darts of the wicked one.¹⁷ And take the helmet of salvation, and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God;¹⁸ praying always with all prayer and supplication in the Spirit, being watchful to this end with all perseverance and supplication for all the saints.”

God’s plan here included more than giving Israel a piece of real estate! [God’s desire was to bring Israel to a place of confidence in Jehovah that they would doubt nothing!](#) Hebrews 3:8-19 (NKJV) *“Do not harden your hearts as in the rebellion, In the day of trial in the wilderness,⁹ Where your fathers tested Me, tried Me, And saw My works forty years.¹⁰ Therefore I was angry with that generation, And said, ‘They always go astray in their heart, And they have not known My ways.’¹¹ So I swore in My wrath, ‘They shall not enter My rest.’”¹² Beware, brethren, lest there be in any of you an evil heart of unbelief in departing from the living God;¹³ but exhort one another daily, while it is called “Today,” lest any of you be hardened through the deceitfulness of sin.¹⁴*

For we have become partakers of Christ if we hold the beginning of our confidence steadfast to the end,
¹⁵ ***while it is said: “Today, if you will hear His voice, Do not harden your hearts as in the rebellion.”*** ¹⁶ ***For who, having heard, rebelled? Indeed, was it not all who came out of Egypt, led by Moses?*** ¹⁷ ***Now with whom was He angry forty years? Was it not with those who sinned, whose corpses fell in the wilderness?*** ¹⁸ ***And to whom did He swear that they would not enter His rest, but to those who did not obey?*** ¹⁹ ***So we see that they could not enter in because of unbelief.*** The underlying message here is that God was teaching them and is in the process of teaching us the value of confidence in His Word!

Hebrews 4:9-11 (NKJV) ***“There remains therefore a rest for the people of God.”*** ¹⁰ ***For he who has entered His rest has himself also ceased from his works as God did from His.*** ¹¹ ***Let us therefore be diligent to enter that rest, lest anyone fall according to the same example of disobedience.***

Unbelief or lack of confidence kept an entire generation of Jews out of Canaan’s land! This was such an unnecessary thing because **Jehovah was willing and able to deliver them!** Notice **Numbers 14:1-9 (NKJV)** ***“So all the congregation lifted up their voices and cried, and the people wept that night.”*** ² ***And all the children of Israel complained against Moses and Aaron, and the whole congregation said to them, “If only we had died in the land of Egypt! Or if only we had died in this wilderness!”*** ³ ***Why has the LORD brought us to this land to fall by the sword,***

that our wives and children should become victims? Would it not be better for us to return to Egypt?”⁴ So they said to one another, “Let us select a leader and return to Egypt.”⁵ Then Moses and Aaron fell on their faces before all the assembly of the congregation of the children of Israel.⁶ But Joshua the son of Nun and Caleb the son of Jephunneh, who were among those who had spied out the land, tore their clothes;⁷ and they spoke to all the congregation of the children of Israel, saying: “The land we passed through to spy out is an exceedingly good land.”⁸ If the LORD delights in us, then He will bring us into this land and give it to us, ‘a land which flows with milk and honey.’⁹ Only do not rebel against the LORD, nor fear the people of the land, for they are our bread; their protection has departed from them, and the LORD is with us. Do not fear them.” In this Scripture, Caleb and Joshua exude confidence in God and Israel concerning their ability to perform the tasks God was calling them to do.

Balaam speaks concerning Israel, [Numbers 24:17-19](#) (NKJV) “... *A Star shall come out of Jacob; A Scepter shall rise out of Israel, And batter the brow of Moab, And destroy all the sons of tumult.¹⁸ “And Edom shall be a possession; Seir also, his enemies, shall be a possession, While Israel does valiantly.¹⁹ Out of Jacob One shall have dominion, And destroy the remains of the city.”*

David said, [Psalm 60:12](#) (NKJV) “*Through God we will do valiantly, For it is He who shall tread down our enemies.*”

When we assimilate the characteristics into our lives which Caleb assimilated, victory will always follow!

[Psalm 91:1-16](#) (NKJV) ***“He who dwells in the secret place of the Most High Shall abide under the shadow of the Almighty. ² I will say of the LORD, “He is my refuge and my fortress; My God, in Him I will trust.”***

³ Surely He shall deliver you from the snare of the fowler And from the perilous pestilence. ⁴ He shall cover you with His feathers, And under His wings you shall take refuge; His truth shall be your shield and buckler. ⁵ You shall not be afraid of the terror by night, Nor of the arrow that flies by day, ⁶ Nor of the pestilence that walks in darkness, Nor of the

destruction that lays waste at noonday. ⁷ A thousand may fall at your side, And ten thousand at your right hand; But it shall not come near you. ⁸ Only with your eyes shall you look, And see the reward of the wicked. ⁹ Because you have made the LORD, who is

my refuge, Even the Most High, your dwelling place, ¹⁰ No evil shall befall you, Nor shall any plague come near your dwelling; ¹¹ For He shall give His angels charge over you, To keep you in all your ways. ¹² In

their hands they shall bear you up, Lest you dash your foot against a stone. ¹³ You shall tread upon the lion and the cobra, The young lion and the serpent you shall trample underfoot. ¹⁴ “Because he has set

his love upon Me, therefore I will deliver him; I will set him on high, because he has known My name. ¹⁵

He shall call upon Me, and I will answer him; I will be with him in trouble; I will deliver him and honor

him. ¹⁶ With long life I will satisfy him, And show him My salvation.”

IV. CALEB HAD A SPIRIT OF CONVICTION...

An opinion isn't worth anything; a conviction is something one would be willing to die for!

Hebrew word **Caleb** (KAW-LABE) means “*Forcible fortitude!*” (Cereal is fortified with 10 essential vitamins) (Woman and husband who went to heaven 10 years too late – ate their oat bran)

The English definition is, “*possessor of the promise.*”

God wants each person young and old to be fortified with the Holy Ghost and possess all His promises!

Acts 1:8 (NKJV) “***But you shall receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you; and you shall be witnesses to Me in Jerusalem, and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the end of the earth.***”

Caleb had been across Jordan and while there he had gone to Mt. Hebron, which is the place of Death. Something began to stir in his spirit as he realized that this is the place where Abraham, Sarah, Isaac, Jacob, and some of the patriarchs are buried! In years to come this would be the place where David's kingdom would be initiated!

Caleb decides that this is his mountain! Forty plus years later Caleb got his mountain! **Joshua 14:6-13 (NKJV)** “***Then the children of Judah came to Joshua in Gilgal. And Caleb the son of Jephunneh the Kenizzite said to him: “You know the word which the LORD said to Moses the man of God concerning you***

and me in Kadesh Barnea. ⁷ I was forty years old when Moses the servant of the LORD sent me from Kadesh Barnea to spy out the land, and I brought back word to him as it was in my heart. ⁸

Nevertheless my brethren who went up with me made the heart of the people melt, but I wholly followed the LORD my God. ⁹ So Moses swore on that day, saying, ‘Surely the land where your foot has trodden shall be your inheritance and your children’s forever, because you have wholly followed the LORD my God.’

¹⁰ And now, behold, the LORD has kept me alive, as He said, these forty-five years, ever since the LORD spoke this word to Moses while Israel wandered in the wilderness; and now, here I am this day, eighty-five years old. ¹¹ As yet I am as strong this day as on the day that Moses sent me; just as my strength was then, so now is my strength for war, both for going out and for coming in. ¹² Now therefore, give me this mountain of which the LORD spoke in that day; for you heard in that day how the Anakim were there, and that the cities were great and fortified. It may be that the LORD will be with me, and I shall be able to drive them out as the LORD said.” ¹³ And Joshua blessed him, and gave Hebron to Caleb the son of Jephunneh as an inheritance.” Notice the lack of criticism here! (Sis Emma Sullivan – “I just want the devil to know whose side I’m on!”)

Caleb says give me this mountain of Death to sin and self! This kind of conviction is what it takes to live a victorious Christian life.

CONCLUSION: Let's get up and move forward, and possess the Land!
God is looking for a group of people who want to have a right spirit!

SONGS: *"I am bound for the Promised Land!"*
"I have decided to follow Jesus!"